



Czech Republic

Once part of Czechoslovakia, a central European communist state in 1948–1989, the Czech Republic peacefully dissolved its union with Slovakia in 1993. It joined the EU in 2004.



GEOGRAPHY

Landlocked in central Europe. Bohemia, the western territory, is a plateau surrounded by mountains. Moravia, in the east, is characterized by hills and lowlands.



CLIMATE

Cool, sometimes cold winters and warm summer months, which bring most of the annual rainfall.



PEOPLE & SOCIETY

Secular and urban society, with high divorce rates. Czechs make up the vast majority of the population, while the next largest group are Moravians. The 300,000 Slovaks left after partition are now permitted dual citizenship. Ethnic tensions are few, but there is widespread hostility toward the Roma minority. A new commercial elite is emerging alongside postcommunist entrepreneurs.



THE ECONOMY

Traditional heavy industries (machinery, iron, car-making) have been successfully privatized. Prague attracts tourists. Skilled workforce. Will join euro in 2013 at earliest.



INSIGHT: *Charles University in Prague was founded in the 13th century*



FACTFILE

OFFICIAL NAME: Czech Republic

DATE OF FORMATION: 1993

CAPITAL: Prague

POPULATION: 10.4 million

TOTAL AREA: 30,450 sq. miles
(78,866 sq. km)

DENSITY: 341 people per sq. mile

LANGUAGES: Czech*, Slovak, Hungarian

RELIGIONS: Roman Catholic 39%,
atheist 38%, other 18%, Protestant 3%,
Hussite 2%

ETHNIC MIX: Czech 90%, other 4%,
Moravian 4%, Slovak 2%

GOVERNMENT: Parliamentary system

CURRENCY: Czech koruna = 100 haleru